FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-21005

Issue Title : 737 MAX - Safran Main Landing Gear Wheel Pressure Loss

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3245-11	-8, -8200, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
01/26/2022	01/19/2026	01/16/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Provide the latest status and milestones updates. In addition, final action was provided to close this FTD article.

Applicability

737MAX airplanes using Wheel Assy P/N C20626200 or High Gross Weight Wheel Assy P/N C20746000.

Description

Boeing has received in-service reports of main landing gear wheel-tire assemblies losing pressure, sometimes at a rate greater than 5% per 24 hours when equipped with Safran Landing Systems wheel assembly P/N C20626200 or P/N C20746000.

Background

Safran Landing Systems main landing gear wheel assembly P/N C20626200 entered service in 2011. Safran Landing Systems modified main landing gear wheel P/N C20626200 in 2016 by adding canals in the wheel half seal groove. The canals allow the wheel/tire assembly to slowly release pressure to prevent wheel fracture if multiple tie bolts are broken, loose, or missing.

The wheel half seal groove canals are included in Safran Landing Systems main landing gear wheel P/N C20626200 Amdt B and later:

- C20626200 Amdt B (Post Safran SB C20626-32-014 dated 20-July-2016)
- C20626200 Amdt C (Post Safran SB C20626-32-014 dated 20-July-2016)
- C20626200 Amdt D (Post Safran SB C20626-32-022 dated 28-Apr-2020, C20626200 Amdt B and Amdt C can be modified to C20626200 Amdt D)
- C20626200 Amdt E (Post Safran SB C20626-32-028 dated 22-July-2022, C20626200 Amdt B, Amdt C, and Amdt D can be modified to C20626200 Amdt E)

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A higher gross weight Safran Landing Systems main landing gear wheel P/N C20746000 entered service in 2018. All amendment levels of the SLS main landing gear wheel P/N C20746000 include canals in the wheel half seal groove:

- C20746000
- C20746000 Amdt A (Post Safran SB C20746-32-001 dated 28-Apr-2020)

Evaluation of removed wheel/tire assemblies has found tire inflation pressure leakage occurring at the main wheel seal area between the inner-and-outer wheel halves and is believed to be caused by a leakage path at the air canals. The tire pressure inflation loss, sometimes at a rate greater than 5% within 24 hours, can result in more frequent tire failures. Tire failure reports received from operators indicate a higher frequency of tire failures occur when tire inflation pressure checks are performed at an interval exceeding 48 elapsed hours. Tire pressure inflation checks need to be performed at an interval not to exceed 48 hours per Maintenance Planning Document (MPD) 32-350-00. Daily tire inflation pressure checks are preferred if possible as discussed in multi-model service letter 737-SL-12-015.

Safran Landing Systems recently released Temporary Revision (TR) for the applicable CMMs regarding wheel-half clamping requirement. This information is provided within the Safran Landing Systems CMMs as 'Caution' statement which states to use a positioning mandrel or equivalent, to evenly press the wheel halves prior to application of the pre-torque with the aim to correctly seat the main packing in its groove. Please refer to the following TR revisions for more information:

- Wheel Assy P/N C20746000, SLS CMM 32-49-84 TR 32-5 dated 15-Dec-2022, incorporated into CMM 32-49-84 dated 15-Jan-2025
- Wheel Assy P/N C20626200, SLS CMM 32-49-83 TR 32-15 dated 15-Dec-2022, incorporated into CMM 32-49-83 dated 08-Nov-2024

Status

Safran Landing Systems has reviewed the use of an alternate grease called Royco 43 for main wheel seal lubrication in order to increase the seal volume for wheel P/N C20626200 and P/N C20746000. In service trials by an Operator has shown a significant drop in wheel pressure loss when using this alternative grease. Due to these findings, Safran Landing Systems has approved the use of Royco 43 per Safran Landing Systems Service Bulletins C20746-32-007 and C20626-32-031.

Safran Landing Systems has redesigned the wheel assembly P/N C20746000 by removing the canals in the wheel half seal groove. However, in order to allow the wheel-tire assembly to slowly release pressure to prevent wheel fracture if multiple tie bolts are broken, loose, or missing, Safran Landing Systems replaced the canals with a new groove that is adjacent to the main packing groove. The intent of the new groove is to generate the extrusion of the main packing in order to slowly decrease the pressure if multiple tie bolts are broken, loose, or missing. Please see attached figure within this FTD article showing the new wheel-half redesign. This redesign has been tested and shown to mitigate wheel pressure loss when the tie bolts are properly assembled.

With testing and analysis now completed, installation of the new wheel-half will modify the High Gross Weight Wheel Assy from P/N C20746000 to P/N C20746001. The wheel assembly C20746001 will be the new production wheel for the 737-7/-8/-8200/-9 fleet when selecting the Safran Landing Systems option. For wheel assembly P/N C20626200, Boeing recommends to perform the action outlined in Safran Landing Systems Service Bulletin C20626-32-031 or procure the new wheel assembly part number C20746001 once it becomes available. Boeing's 737NG/MAX Interchangeability drawing 277A6001 will be revised to include P/N C20746001. In addition, drawing 277A6001 Rev R or latest, contains Table 3C (MAX applicable) which allows intermix of all Safran wheels within the boundaries of the interchangeability drawing. Note: If required, please refer to 'How To Use Interchangeability Tables' within the engineering drawing 277A6001.

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Interim Action

Boeing re-emphasizes the importance of the 737MAX MPD Item Number 32-350-00 instructions to check the tires for proper inflation at an interval not to exceed 48 elapsed clock hours to ensure that the correct wheel/tire assembly pressure is maintained. Operators of the affected Safran Landing Systems MLG wheel P/Ns are encouraged to perform tire pressure checks daily if possible to ensure that any leaking wheel/tire assemblies are promptly identified and removed from service in order to prevent tire failures. Tire inflation pressure checks should be performed with the tires cool, at least two hours after landing. Hot tire pressure checks may not reliably detect a low tire pressure condition, which can lead to tire failure. When checking the pressure value, ensure to follow the AMM table that states 'Maintenance Actions', the actions should be based on your actual reading value. If the wheel-tire assembly has a trend of losing 5% or more of nominal tire pressure, replace the wheel-tire assembly. A loss of 10% or more requires replacement per AMM requirements. Please refer to Service Letter 737-SL-12-015 for more information regarding the importance of tire pressure checks.

In addition, Boeing recommends installation of a new wheel-half seal during wheel and tire assembly per Safran Landing Systems applicable CMMs. When installing this seal, Boeing recommends using Royco 43 grease and the associated installation procedure as outlined by Safran Landing Systems Service Bulletins C20746-32-007 and C20626-32-031 for the specific wheel assembly part number. When checking the wheel-tire assembly for leakage, Boeing recommends performing the tire inflation leak check found in Testing and Fault Isolation section of Boeing Wheel/Tire Assembly CMM 32-11-17 Rev 48 dated 01-Nov-2022 (incorporates Temporary Revision 32-3007 dated 9-Jul-2022) or later. The leakage check was revised to have its pressure values higher in order to capture leaking wheels during standard wheel shop visits. If the wheel/tire assembly does not leak through the seal installed between the inner-and-outer wheel halves, and the wheel and tire assembly is determined to be serviceable per applicable CMM requirements, then the wheel and tire assembly is acceptable to be installed on the aircraft per AMM requirements.

Final Action

Safran Landing Systems has created a new wheel half part number A39346. When using this new wheel half part number, the wheel assembly P/N C20746000 will become P/N C20746001. This wheel assembly will be first delivered on a Boeing production airplane in August 2025 (LN 9259 and on). For the in-service fleet, Safran Landing System has created SB C20746-32-009 which contains information to install the new wheel half part number. This Safran Service Bulletin modifies the exiting wheel assembly P/N C20746000 to P/N C20746001. Please contact your local Safran Customer Support Manager (CSM) for more information.

For the in-service 737MAX fleet that is experiencing wheel pressure loss, Boeing has released Service Bulletin 737-32-1595 recommending replacement of wheel assembly P/N C20626200 and C20746000 with P/N C20746001. Please review Boeing's interchangeability drawing 277A6001 Rev R or latest for interchangeability information on wheel assembly P/N C20746001.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Alternate grease seal - Wheel Assembly P/N C20746000 and P/N C20626200

- Analysis Completion: August 2023
- Solution Selection: September 2023
- Release of Safran Service Bulletin: December 2023

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Wheel Assembly Re-Design Effort

- Analysis Completion: September 2023 (Complete)
- Solution Selection: September 2024 (Complete)
- Qualification Test Report (QTR): January 2025 (Complete)
- Entry Into Service (EIS): August 2025 (Complete)
- Release of Safran Service Bulletin: July 2025 (Complete)

Boeing Release of Service Bulletin:

- SB 737-32-1595: November 2025 (Complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Maintenance Planning Document (MPD)	32-350-00		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-11-17		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-49-83		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20626-32-014		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20626-32-022		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20746-32-001		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-49-84		
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	12-15-51-610		
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	12-15-51-780		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-12-015		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20626-32-028		
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-32-22001		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20746-32-007		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20626-32-031		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20746-32-009		
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-32-1595		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
MLG (SDW) Wheel Assembly	C20626200	Safran Landing Systems	F6137
Inner Half-Wheel (SDW)	A37952	Safran Landing Systems	F6137
Inner Half-Wheel (RSDW)	A38109	Safran Landing Systems	F6137

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MLG (RSDW) Wheel Assembly	C20746000	Safran Landing Systems	F6137
Preformed Packing (O-Ring) Seal	NAS1611-388	Safran Landing Systems	F6137
Preformed Packing (O-Ring) Seal	NAS1611-388A	Safran Landing Systems	F6137

Related Categories

- Best Practices / Operational Efficiency : Operational / Maintenance-focused best practices, techniques, health checks or recommendations for preserving aircraft efficiency.
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

Attachments:

a) Redesign

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